

C1 GERMAN FLUENCY SELF-EVALUATION CHECKLIST



How to Use This Checklist

This checklist is designed to help you track your progress and determine if you are ready to pass a C1-level German proficiency exam. C1 represents advanced fluency, where you use German flexibly, precisely, and elegantly across personal, academic, and professional contexts.

While Using This Checklist

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Review each item carefully.

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Check off the skills and knowledge you have mastered.

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Focus your study efforts on the items you haven't yet mastered.

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Be honest! This is for your personal growth.

CEFR Descriptions for C1 Level:

Listening

☐

I can understand extended speech even when it is not clearly structured and when relationships are only implied and not explicitly signaled. I can understand television programs and films without too much effort.

Reading

☐

I can understand long and complex factual and literary texts, appreciating distinctions of style. I can understand specialized articles and longer technical instructions, even when they do not relate to my field.

Spoken Interaction

☐

I can express myself fluently and spontaneously without much obvious searching for expressions. I can use language flexibly and effectively for social and professional purposes.

Spoken Production

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I can present clear, detailed descriptions of complex subjects, integrating sub-themes, developing particular points, and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion.

Writing

☐

I can express myself in clear, well-structured text, expressing points of view at some length. I can write about complex subjects in a letter, an essay, or a report, underlining what I consider to be the salient issues.

GENERAL ABILITIES

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Understand fast, complex speech even when relationships are implied.

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Follow TV programs, films, and live debates without difficulty.

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Read and analyze complex factual, literary, and technical texts.

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Express yourself fluently and spontaneously across contexts.

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Adapt language flexibly for social, academic, and professional settings.

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Write structured essays, reports, and formal correspondence.

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Present complex ideas clearly and with nuance.

GRAMMAR TOPICS

Verbs

- ☐ Use Konjunktiv II for nuanced hypotheticals, wishes, and regrets.
- ☐ Use Konjunktiv I for formal indirect speech.
- ☐ Master verbal nouns and nominalization for formal writing.
- ☐ Differentiate complex separable/inseparable verbs (übersetzen, durchfahren).
- ☐ Use advanced modal verb combinations and double infinitives.

Sentence Structure

- ☐ Form deeply nested relative and subordinate clauses.
- ☐ Use inversion for stylistic emphasis (Nie zuvor habe ich...).
- ☐ Master causal, concessive, and conditional clauses.
- ☐ Expand clause types for stylistic variety.

GRAMMAR TOPICS

Passive Voice

- ☐ Use passive with modal verbs across tenses.
- ☐ Form impersonal passive constructions.
- ☐ Use stylistically elevated passive forms (Es wird angenommen, dass...).

Nouns and Articles

- ☐ Nominalize verbs for formal and academic writing.
- ☐ Use advanced weak noun structures.
- ☐ Master formal genitive constructions.

Pronouns

- ☐ Use advanced relative pronouns with prepositions (worüber, wovon).
- ☐ Expand usage of indefinite and demonstrative pronouns for emphasis.

GRAMMAR TOPICS

Adjectives

- ☐ Use participial adjectives (faszinierendes Buch, beschädigte Ware).
- ☐ Form complex comparative structures (Je mehr..., desto...).
- ☐ Master prepositional adjective phrases (geeignet für, angewiesen auf).

Prepositions

- ☐ Use genitive prepositions for formal writing (aufgrund, infolge).
- ☐ Use prepositional adverbs (daraufhin, darüber hinaus).
- ☐ Incorporate idiomatic prepositional phrases (im Rahmen von, zur Verfügung stehen).

GRAMMAR TOPICS

Conjunctions

- ☐ Use advanced connectors (sodass, sofern, wobei, dennoch).
- ☐ Construct correlative phrases (Nicht nur..., sondern auch).
- ☐ Use concessive inversion for emphasis.

Tenses

- ☐ Master Plusquamperfekt for complex timelines.
- ☐ Use Futur II for speculation and assumptions.

Reported Speech (Indirekte Rede)

- ☐ Layer indirect speech across multiple narrative levels.

Modal Particles

- ☐ Use modal particles for emotional nuance and stance (ja, wohl).

GRAMMAR TOPICS

Stylistic Tools

- ☐ **Use complex negation for emphasis (Keineswegs war das die Absicht).**
- ☐ **Shift between formal and informal registers appropriately.**
- ☐ **Use rhetorical questions, parallelism, and emphasis effectively.**

CONVERSATIONAL & COMMUNICATIVE TOPICS

Academic & Professional Communication

- ☐ Present structured arguments and essays.
- ☐ Defend complex viewpoints in discussions.
- ☐ Participate in academic seminars and debates.
- ☐ Summarize and critique articles or presentations.
- ☐ Write formal emails, proposals, and reports.

Debating & Persuasion

- ☐ Debate controversial issues persuasively.
- ☐ Use hedging and intensification in arguments.

Social, Cultural & Political Topics

- ☐ Analyze societal trends and compare cultural practices.
- ☐ Discuss international and political issues with clarity.

CONVERSATIONAL & COMMUNICATIVE TOPICS

Abstract and Theoretical Topics

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Discuss ethics, philosophy, and abstract ideas.

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Express uncertainty and conditional ideas fluently.

Self-Reflection & Metacognition

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Reflect on personal growth and learning strategies.

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Express emotional nuance and justify decisions.

Workplace & Collaboration

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Lead discussions and meetings effectively.

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Negotiate terms and mediate disagreements.

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Give and receive constructive feedback professionally.

Storytelling & Descriptions

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Narrate events with emotional depth and complexity.

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Interpret literature, films, or art using advanced vocabulary.